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ANI

INDIA'S ASSAM BATTLES RISING FLOODWATERS

Floods continued to wreak havoc in Assam yesterday, affecting more than 310,000 people and forcing large-scale rescue operations, while relentless monsoon rain prompted flood and landslide alerts across Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir and parts of Rajasthan. Authorities said the worst-hit districts in Assam, like Jorhat, remained under water as the Indian Army, disaster response teams and railway authorities stepped up relief efforts amid forecasts of more rain.

SEE ALSO P12

New Indian passport provider in the UAE

DUBAI

BY ANUPAM VARMA
News and Business Editor
DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Indian passport, visa and attestation services across the UAE will now be handled by Al Hind Tours and Travels, with the new system coming into effect from today. The services have been outsourced through 16 Indian Consular Application Centres (ICACs) across the UAE, the Indian Consulate in Dubai announced late yesterday evening.

The announcement means applicants seeking passport renewals, visa services and document attestation will now need to use the new provider for these consular services. Appointments can be booked through the newly-launched Consular Seva in UAE portal, the mission clarified.

Legal battles

The transition follows the Indian government's decision to appoint a new service provider for consular services in the UAE after the previous outsourcing arrangement ended following several legal battles.

Applicants with upcoming appointments are advised to use the new booking platform and check the latest guidelines before visiting a centre.

The transition to Al Hind Tours & Travels follows weeks of legal uncertainty over who should run Indian passport, visa and attestation services in the UAE.

RENEWED IRANIAN ATTACKS ON BAHRAIN, KUWAIT AND JORDAN DRAWS UAE'S IRE

Latest strikes target critical infrastructure in Gulf states

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The UAE has strongly condemned what it described as renewed Iranian missile and drone attacks targeting Bahrain, Kuwait and Jordan.

In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs said the attacks were a flagrant violation of the sovereignty of the three countries and posed a threat to their security and stability.

The ministry reaffirmed the UAE's full solidarity with Bahrain, Kuwait and Jordan, and expressed support for all measures taken to protect their security and stability.

Kuwaiti interceptions

Yesterday evening, air defence systems had intercepted Iranian missile and drone attacks according to the General Staff of Kuwait's armed forces.

Kuwait said that Iran had again attacked power and desalination plants critical to the nation.

The statement from Kuwait's Electricity, Water and Renewable Energy Ministry said that Tehran had struck the plants for a fourth day in a row on Monday night. It said the attacks sparked fires and caused damage, adding it was working to repair the sites.

Kuwait also summoned Iran's ambassador yesterday to protest an Iranian attack on the Kuwaiti tanker Kaifan while it was transiting the Strait of Hormuz, saying several crew members were injured in the incident.

10-DAY TRUCE TALKS PUSH UP WORLD MARKETS

Global markets rose yesterday as investors weighed a proposed 10-day US-Iran ceasefire against attacks and higher oil prices.

Axios and Reuters reported mediators including Qatar, Egypt and Pakistan had proposed the truce, pending a final decision from US President Donald Trump.

Most Gulf stock markets ended higher yesterday, with UAE benchmarks in Abu Dhabi and Dubai both up 0.3 per cent, while Qatar rose 0.2 per cent. European markets advanced, while a rebound in technology shares helped Wall Street's S&P 500 and Nasdaq rise around 1 per cent. George Pavel of trading platform Naga.com Middle East said diplomacy could improve conditions for economies and stock markets.

Brent climbed 2 per cent to a five-week high of \$91.34. SEB Research warned of "a more prolonged stalemate" involving energy flows, higher oil prices and recurring attacks.

— Gulf News Report

Jordan neutralises attacks

The Jordanian military announced yesterday it had intercepted two Iranian attacks, the latest by the Islamic republic on countries in the region following the resumption of the Middle East war. The military's "air defence systems intercepted and shot down three Iranian missiles targeting the kingdom at midday today", the army said in a statement, adding that there had been no casualties or damage caused.

Jordan's Armed Forces earlier said they neutralised five Iranian drones, adding that the operation was carried out "with efficiency and precision" in line with operational requirements and established defensive procedures.

Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) confirmed the first of the attacks, claiming in a statement that they had targeted a "complex housing US

terrorist forces in the region of Rukban".

Bahrain sounds sirens

Bahrain yesterday sounded sirens after the country's military had said it intercepted Iranian attacks.

"The siren has been sounded, Citizens and residents are urged to remain calm and head to the nearest safe place," the interior ministry said in a statement. "The air defences of the Bahrain Defence Force intercepted and destroyed a number of Iranian aerial aggressions," the military added in a statement on X.

Iran's Revolutionary Guards claimed it targeted Amazon's data infrastructure in Bahrain with cruise missiles. In a statement carried by Iran's semi-official Tasnim news agency, the IRGC said its aerospace force carried out the attack in response to recent US strikes on

civilian infrastructure in Darkhovin.

Qatar condemns

Qatar has condemned remarks by the Houthi military spokesman accusing Saudi Arabia of imposing a blockade on Yemen and enforcing a maritime embargo. In a statement, Qatar's Ministry of Foreign Affairs reaffirmed its full solidarity with Saudi Arabia and backed all measures taken by the Kingdom to protect its sovereignty and security.

Israeli forces carried out "large bombings" in southern Lebanon yesterday, detonating explosives in the towns of Kfartebnit and Mais Al Jabal, according to the official National News Agency.

Meanwhile, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said yesterday that communication with Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei had "increased", adding that the country's decisions continued to be guided by his directives, according to Iranian state media.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio said that Washington remains willing to pursue a diplomatic solution with Iran, but insisted any path toward de-escalation depends on Tehran ending its attacks on international shipping and complying with its commitments, even as US strikes on Iran continued for the 10th consecutive day.

Pakistan's Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif called for restraint from all warring sides during a meeting with Iran's interior minister yesterday.

SEE ALSO P7

Adnoc to unlock gas equal to 10% of UAE demand

Umm Shaif will add over 600 million scfd, with production expected by 2030

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Adnoc has approved a \$6.2 billion investment to develop the Umm Shaif Gas Cap, a project expected to unlock gas volumes equivalent to almost 10 per cent of the UAE's current daily consumption.

The final investment decision covers the development of the gas cap at Abu Dhabi's longest-operating offshore field, alongside Adnoc's international partners TotalEnergies, Eni and China National Petroleum Corporation. Production is expected to begin by 2030, adding more than 600 million standard cubic feet per day of natural gas and associated gas liquids to the UAE's energy supply.

The additional output will support domestic energy security while supplying industrial customers and infrastructure linked to the growth of artificial intelligence, according to Ad-

noc. The UAE holds the world's seventh-largest gas reserves, giving Adnoc a substantial resource base as it expands production and builds its liquefied natural gas business.

Rising demand

Natural gas from Umm Shaif will serve Adnoc's domestic and international customers while increasing the volume available to meet rising industrial and power demand.

"Adnoc is accelerating its integrated gas strategy to further harness the UAE's vast gas resources and expand our global LNG platform, as global demand for natural gas continues to rise," said Dr Sultan Ahmed Al Jaber, UAE Minister of Industry and Advanced Technology and Adnoc Managing Director and Group CEO.

The Umm Shaif decision follows the award of the Bab Gas Cap concession agreement by the Supreme Council for Financial and Economic Affairs.

Bab is expected to add a further 1.5 billion standard cubic feet per day of natural gas and associated gas liquids, expanding the supply available from Abu Dhabi's onshore resources.

SEE ALSO P-I

NATION

Etihad Rail's Dubai station almost ready to welcome passengers | P2

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IN FOCUS

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